

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Articles 1-4: the territorial power hierarchy

ARTICLE 1

India, that is Bharat = Union of States
territory = States + Union territories + acquired territories

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ARTICLE 2

Parliament admits into Union or establishes new States

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ARTICLE 3

Parliament forms new States and alters area, boundary or name

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ARTICLE 4

consequential First/Fourth Schedule changes and supplemental provisions
laws under Articles 2 and 3 are not amendments under Article 368

FIRST SCHEDULE = living ledger of States and Union territories

PRINCIPLE: States have constitutional status, but no right to secede.

MUST REMEMBER: Articles 1-4 and the First/Fourth Schedules separate territorial identity,
admission or establishment, internal reorganisation and consequential schedule changes
within an indestructible Union.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Article 3 procedure: consultation without a State veto

PRESIDENT'S RECOMMENDATION REQUIRED

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BILL affects area, boundary or name of a State?

+-- YES -> President refers bill to affected State legislature

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+-- specifies time for expressing views

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+-- may extend that time

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+-- Parliament is not bound by those views

+-- NO State affected -> proviso referral does not arise in that form

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PARLIAMENT passes by ordinary legislative majority

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PRESIDENTIAL ASSENT -> territorial and Schedule changes

State view is required consultation, not consent.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Article 2, Article 3 and foreign-territory transfer are distinct

QUESTION	CONSTITUTIONAL ROUTE
admit or establish new State	Article 2
reorganise existing Indian unit	Article 3
acquire foreign territory	sovereign power; Article 1 can accommodate it
cede Indian territory	constitutional amendment under Article 368
settle uncertain boundary	no cession if agreement only identifies boundary

BERUBARI UNION (1960)

cession of Indian territory cannot be completed through Article 3 alone.

MAGANBHAI ISHWARBHAI PATEL (1969)

boundary settlement differs from cession.

100TH AMENDMENT, 2015

constitutional route used for India-Bangladesh land-boundary exchange.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: First Schedule as a constitutional change ledger

TERRITORIAL LAW UNDER ARTICLE 2 OR 3

- +-- changes First Schedule: State and Union-territory description
- +-- may change Fourth Schedule: Rajya Sabha seat allocation
- +-- may include supplemental, incidental and consequential provisions

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ARTICLE 4 DECLARATION

such law is not deemed an Article 368 amendment

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ORDINARY LEGISLATIVE ROUTE

LIMIT

Article 4 supports territorial reorganisation;
it does not bypass Article 368 for unrelated constitutional changes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Integration and linguistic reorganisation, 1947-1956

1947-49 accession and integration of princely states
1950 Part A, B, C and D classification begins
1948 Dhar Commission cautions against language-only reorganisation
1949 JVP Committee postpones linguistic reorganisation
1952 Potti Sriramulu's death intensifies Andhra demand
1953 Andhra State formed; States Reorganisation Commission appointed
1955 Fazl Ali Commission report
1956 States Reorganisation Act + Seventh Amendment
+-- language accepted with unity, administration and economy
+-- Part classifications abolished
+-- States and Union territories reorganised

Language became accommodation's basis, not an automatic sole test.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Post-1956 map-making: reorganisation, creation and renaming

1956 SETTLEMENT

- +-- 1960 Maharashtra + Gujarat
- +-- 1963 Nagaland
- +-- 1966 Haryana + Chandigarh; Punjab reorganised
- +-- 1971 Himachal Pradesh
- +-- 1972 Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura
- +-- 1975 Sikkim becomes a State
- +-- 1987 Mizoram, Arunachal Pradesh and Goa
- +-- 2000 Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand and Jharkhand
- +-- 2014 Telangana
- +-- 2019 Jammu and Kashmir reorganised into two Union territories

RENAMING uses Article 3 when a State name changes.

CURRENT MAP IN SOURCE: 28 States and 8 Union territories.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: A State legislature supplies non-binding views under Article 3; Article 4 uses ordinary legislative procedure, while foreign cession requires Article 368 under Berubari Union (1960) and a mere boundary settlement may not.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Jammu and Kashmir reorganisation as an Article 3 stress test

2019 REORGANISATION -> J&K UT WITH LEGISLATURE + LADAKH UT WITHOUT LEGISLATURE

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IN RE ARTICLE 370 (2023 INSC 1058)

- +-- State legislature's Article 3 views are recommendatory
- +-- carving Ladakh as a UT upheld under Article 3(a) + Explanation I
- +-- whole-State-to-two-UT conversion question NOT finally decided
- +-- J&K Statehood restoration directed at the earliest

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STATUS CHECKED 28 AUG 2026

No enacted restoration located; Ladakh Statehood/Sixth-Schedule demands remain under dialogue.

EXAM LIMIT: do not say the Court generally approved every State-to-UT conversion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: New-State demand: democratic claim versus viable federal unit

CLAIM FOR NEW STATE

identity + distance from capital + uneven development + administrative access

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CONSTITUTIONAL RESPONSE

Article 3 reorganisation after required consultation

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TESTS

- +-- administrative viability
- +-- fiscal and resource sustainability
- +-- minority protection inside proposed unit
- +-- water, capital, assets, debt and employees
- +-- security and territorial integrity
- +-- democratic legitimacy and transition costs

Smaller can improve access; it does not automatically produce capacity or equality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Exact verified PYQ controls: wording, demand and answer ownership

2025 PRELIMS GS-I Q52

Arunachal Pradesh + Nagaland + Tripura pairs -> official key C: all three.

Nagaland: Statehood Act and accompanying Thirteenth Amendment are not mutually exclusive.

2018 MAINS GS-I Q12 | 15 MARKS | 250 WORDS

"Discuss whether formation of new states in recent times is beneficial or not for the economy of India."

Answer demand = economic benefit, capacity, fiscal viability and transition costs.

2022 MAINS GS-I Q11 | 15 MARKS | 250 WORDS

Political and administrative reorganization has been a continuous ongoing process since the mid-nineteenth century -> prove continuity with colonial + post-1947 examples.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Exact 10/15/20-mark architecture: flexible territory within an indestructible Union

10 MARKS / 150 WORDS

Article 1 thesis -> Articles 2/3 distinction -> Article 3 procedure -> one case -> verdict.

15 MARKS / 250 WORDS

Articles 1-4 + First/Fourth Schedules -> history -> case law -> federal balance -> graded verdict.

20 MARKS / 250 WORDS

Add chronology as argument, Explanation I State/UT nuance, exact J&K holding, criticism and reform.
Use validity -> legitimacy -> prudence; never substitute a current proposal for enacted law.

ANSWER CONTROL

Every model: evidence -> mechanism -> analysis -> limit -> verdict -> answer-specific improvement.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Qualified final synthesis: flexible map, protected sovereignty, negotiated legitimacy

INTERNAL FLEXIBILITY

Articles 3-4 permit ordinary-law reorganisation after constitutionally required consultation.

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SOVEREIGNTY LIMIT

Berubari Union (1960) excludes foreign cession; Article 368 supplies the constitutional route.

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FEDERAL LEGITIMACY

State views are not a veto, but transparent consultation, viability and negotiated transition matter.

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CURRENT-LAW DISCIPLINE

28 States + 8 UTs; J&K remains a UT with Legislature on the 28 Aug 2026 check.

FINAL VERDICT

Article 3 is a centralising safety valve whose legitimacy depends on using flexibility as constitutional accommodation, not as a substitute for federal trust.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Current territorial status and authoritative-source gate

CURRENT MAP, RECHECKED 5 SEP 2026 -> 28 STATES + 8 UNION TERRITORIES

J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 -> UT of J&K + UT of Ladakh

IN RE ARTICLE 370, 11 DEC 2023 -> 2019 measures upheld; early statehood restoration recorded

NO OPERATIVE RESTORATION NOTIFICATION LOCATED -> J&K remains a UT

SOURCE ORDER: Constitution -> India Code -> Supreme Court -> MHA -> textbook.

LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: State/UT counts, J&K status and reorganisation claims are date-sensitive:

use the Constitution, India Code, MHA and Supreme Court, and never turn an assurance to restore statehood into an accomplished legal notification.